Reacting to the Blue Wave: Is the Market Overreacting?

Podcast: Know your risk

AI Executive Summary

1. Core Thesis: The episode argues that while the 2024 election results represent a historic shift in political power and a significant "blue wave" for Democrats, the financial market's reaction has been muted due to inherent equities' tolerance for gridlock, which limits the likelihood of major policy shocks. While AI hype faces potential headwinds from US state-level regulatory resistance regarding data center capacity and capital expenditure costs, global diversification—specifically into Chinese Tech and International markets—is positioned well for devaluation trends. Furthermore, Healthcare and Biotech remain robust sectors due to their independence from geopolitical conflicts and tech regulation tailwinds. Investors should focus on risk management and long-term portfolio positioning for 2027 rather than reacting to short-term political volatility or overvaluing immediate election impacts on asset classes.

2. Key Arguments & Data:

3. **Market Performance:** S&P closed up 1.65% (Equal Weight up ~1.9%), Russell 2000 up 2.2%, AI down 3%, Hyper-scalars up, Tech stocks (XAS) up ~2%.
4. **Energy Markets:** Oil closed down ~8% (drop of over $8/bbl), signaling a de-escalation of war premium or Middle East risk; Gold and miners up (~9%) as an alternative hedge; 10-year yields down ~8%; Dollar down 36 cents.
5. **Geopolitical Dynamics:** The war in the Middle East remains unresolved with high escalation risk over the next two months, but public pressure against Trump may reduce his willingness to engage further; Democrats have no incentive to escalate due to domestic political costs (Pentagon relations).
6. **AI & Technology Regulation:** US state governments (e.g., Texas) are restricting or resisting massive data center construction; local NIMBYism is driving up power/water costs and slowing capex growth.

7. **International Opportunity:** International markets performed strongly (China Tech +4%, Ireland/Italy/Turkey/AU +5%) due to currency devaluation trade-offs, reduced US geopolitical risk premiums, and political resistance against US-centric tech expansion.
8. **Healthcare/Biotech:** Sector uncorrelated with political/economic volatility, benefiting from AI integration in medicine; XBI (Healthcare ETF) up 6.6% in a single day.

9. **Political Lessons:** Republicans failed to fulfill campaign promises (inflation control, border policy) leading to voter revolt (comparable to the Clinton era backlash); Democrats pivoted toward economic pragmatism over "culture war" issues; political polarization creates volatility rather than stability.

10. Actionable Takeaways:

11. **Diversify Geographically:** Increase exposure to International markets and Chinese Tech companies that benefit from potential US regulatory slowdowns on AI data center expansion.
12. **Sector Rotation:** Overweight Healthcare, Biotech, and Pharma stocks due to their resilience against interest rate volatility, political gridlock risks, and favorable AI adoption in drug development.
13. **Monitor Capex Trends:** Watch for signs of reduced capital expenditure by US hyperscalers; slowing capex growth is viewed as a positive correction preventing unsustainable valuations and potential surplus capacity later.
14. **Risk Management Focus:** Adopt the Bulwark Capital "Taking Control Live" strategy to lower risk, lower cost, and increase upside; focus on portfolio positioning for 2027 rather than trying to predict immediate election impacts on markets.
15. **Avoid Political Noise:** Do not trade based solely on election outcomes or specific political promises; recognize that market logic often favors gridlock over sudden policy shifts that could disrupt the business environment.

Full Transcript

Hey guys, the market loves gridlock in DC. It loves when one party's in the White House and one party's in Congress. Inflation, interest rates, AI spending, midterm results, you name it, you can't control any of it. But there is one thing that you can control, and that is how your retirement portfolio is positioned for 2027. Join Bulwark Capital, Zach Abraham, for his free Taking Control Live webinar, November 19th at 3.30 p.m. Pacific Time. At our webinar, we'll review the forces that shaped this year's markets and what we're watching as investors head into next year. Bulwark is focused on risk management.

always looking for opportunities to lower your risk, lower cost, and give your retirement as much upside as possible. You can't control what happens next, but you can control how you prepare for it. Investment advisory services offer through Trek Financial LLC, an SEC-registered investment advisor. Investments involve risk and are not guaranteed. Past performance doesn't guarantee future results. Trek 26116. The opinions expressed in this program are for general informational purposes only and are not intended to provide specific advice or recommendations for any individual or on any specific security. It is only intended to provide education about the financial industry. To determine which investments may be appropriate for you, consult your financial advisor prior to investing. Any past performance discussed during this program is no guarantee of future results. Any indices referenced for comparison are unmanaged and cannot be invested into directly. Any references to performance of securities are thought to be materially accurate and actual performance may differ. As always, please remember investing involves a risk and possible loss of principal capital. Please seek advice from a licensed professional.

You gotta go big or go home, man. Anyway, welcome to another edition of The Daily Dots. And I'm joined as always by the brain trust himself, Mr. Chase Taylor. You caught us mid discussion about how I'm about to commission a portrait, a painting, oil. It's gotta be oil. Oil like canvas. Yeah. And with an Ascot, maybe a smoking jacket, you know, looking real stately. That's what the office needs, man. Okay, well, certainly a lot to talk about

today. Too much to talk about. Yeah. Probably a surprising market response to a lot of folks, especially if you're on the right. I will tell you the magnitude of the move, surprise me. I don't really see that.

But it doesn't surprise you know, I think there was an attitude about a lot of people on the right that if this blue wave happens all the markets gonna get killed and My response back to them is a guys the market loves gridlock in DC It loves when one party's in in the White House of one parties in the in the in Congress So I didn't and I think you and I spoke to it I didn't really see the election having a meaningful impact on equities one way or the other And I don't think it will in a way that's lasting. And we can get into more of this. I think part of this move today that does make sense is it seems like a little bit of the war premium is coming out of things, certainly out of oil. I think that that's premature, but I think that that does make some sense because I think with what happened last night in the elections, it feels pretty moderate to make the statement that this war spinning out of control got a lot less likely last night. It certainly could still. But I'll say that I'm looking at it right now and going, I'm not surprised that the market did not get hammered at all. If you would have told me that election would have happened, I thought the market would have been moderately green, but not red. That would have been my thought. Or maybe red for one day and then bounce back. You know what I mean? Just because, again, regardless of which way it went, I just didn't see anything changing massively as it related to an economic basis. But I will say that a lot of the market moves today are kind of hard for me to wrap my head around. Yeah.

I know I'm cool. You you and I have only talked about it fleeting. Yeah. So I think I think I think today makes for a good podcast because you you and I have agreed on like everything lately. And I think finally we don't I think we see see today different and some of these developments different, which is healthy and probably good for the listeners. But but you know, I think we should both preface by saying like like the first day after A big election, especially I think you were going you're in negative gamma going in like I don't trust any of it to be Signal and not noise yet But I think I think I think oil down you can make the case for why that makes sense I push back on that and then you can and then on the flip side with AI down and private scalars up I think you can make the case for why that makes sense and I

actually Think it makes sense and I know and I know from earlier talks you much less so so I think that's gonna be good conversation Should we knock out the rundown first if you know what we're talking about? Okay under a rock. Yeah And first of all if no one was paying attention What we're talking about before the rundown is I mean pretty pretty deeply historic midterm loss for one party. I mean Everyone knew they were going to lose the house. Most people thought they would probably lose the Senate. None of that was that controversial. But they lost a lot of the Senate. They lost a good bit of those races big. But more of the point to me is some of the races that was like, whoa, was... I mean, they lost a lot of governorships in purple states, in red states.

I mean, Texas is literally every single state election. So like you're talking railroad commissioner, like dog catcher, agriculture, like czar. If it was on the ballot, they lost. And that's a big deal in Texas. If you remember, there was big fights over redistricting. At last check, the GOP had two wins and 12 losses. And in the districts, they redistricted for themselves. So they gerrymandered it to win and they lost. 12 of 14, there's still like one or two that were up in the air. Like that's a big sign for like bad, right? Like, no. And this gerrymandering debate, the Democrats trying to weaponize that against Republicans. I thought was one of the funniest things that Paul takes because you know what they're working on this morning, gerrymandering it right back in their advantage. I, it's, it's hilarious. But you know, it doesn't always work. No. And here's the other thing.

especially when you've got a party in power in the administration that literally violates every single one of their campaign promises and like what you saw last night in a lot of ways was the inverse of the 2024 election right like meaning you know these places were trumped by one by 15 he lost by 15 right what you you had a group of people who believed what he promised felt like they got lied to and and cheated and they swung a hundred percent back the other direction and and The the incredible thing about it and this is why I've used the term over and over and over I thought this would be seen as one of the greatest political cell phones in history and It is it is You walked into it. This is all obvious for the last six months. That's the crazy thing. When he went into Iran back in February, you and I were saying, if this does not get resolved really quickly, which we don't

think it will, the midterms are going to be a bloodbath. We were saying that in February. Now, look, you didn't have to be some brilliant political pundit to come to that conclusion. You just had to understand basic geography and basic geopolitics, and you realized They close it straight. You ain't going to get it open. Oil prices are going to moon. Inflation is going to run out of control. And all of that's going to land on our shores 90 days prior to the election. And it just, I mean, it was self-evident. Here we are. And old Trumpy is just choking on this one. And it's completely self-generated. It was completely self-inflicted. And I think one of the other things people need to be cautious of is You know, Brent put out a couple, our buddy Brent put out a couple of good posts that I completely agreed with. Every single election, this election reminded me a lot of 94. The new contract with America, right? When Gingrich and those guys, because it was historical on that level, maybe not quite that big because the Republicans hadn't controlled the Congress in over like 60 years at that point. So that was probably, that was even more historical and had more magnitude. But you know, go look at why that one happened.

People felt really disillusioned and felt like Clinton had lied to him, you know, and didn't fulfill his campaign promises in the first two years. And people revolted. And if you look at what they were mad at Clinton about in 92 to 94, I think you can easily a fair-minded person can make the case that Trump gave the voting base three times the reasons to be mad at him that Clinton did at that period of time. just a complete violation of his campaign promises, and then believing with unbelievable arrogance that somehow his cult of personality would carry the day. And it did, it did carry the day just for the other party. And I just, I was not surprised by the nationwide outcomes last night at all. As a matter of fact, they were very in line with what I was thinking. I remember thinking, you know, You and I talked about it. I was like, if it's not a bloodbath, I'll be absolutely shocked. I just didn't see any. There was no stopgap. There was no reason for it not to be a bloodbath. I mean, you know what I mean? Like, all true. I still I'm still surprised by governorships, lieutenant governorships, like, like rural rural counties, Latino vote, like that stuff. Young men, actually, that stuff went back the other way. Hard like that. Yeah, no surprising. And it should.

Be a big deal to them. I think it also potentially says something more troubling about what's going on in the country meaning What I think use Trump had happened to him last night exactly what he was in 2016 I've always thought ironically and I can't stand the guy for a whole host of reasons but I've I've always thought that Michael Moore's assessment of the 2016 election was the most spot on which is he said and he typified the way I was thinking in 2016 which is the support for Trump. Trump is a Molotov cocktail that the constituency can pick up and throw at the system. Last night the DSA, the Democratic Socialists and all the far left. So I do disagree then. Well, let me finish the thought for God's sake. Trump lost the people that swung to him that carried through what he referred to as his historical win. Virtually 100% of that voting block plus some flipped the other side last night. And the way you know that is you look at the Republican turnout numbers. Republicans turned out they just voted the other way.

Yeah, that's what fans made. Yeah. Yeah, they turned out they went the other way. I am telling you that is there a cultural warming toward things socialism? Yes. But I think that that is pardoned upon over Trump. I think people were pissed and disgusted by Trump not going after Epstein. I think that was a huge one. And then the Iran War. And I think they grabbed any alternative and hooked it back at it. And I think that's the majority of the story of what happened last night. Yeah, I think you're right. But I think you didn't quite say what I thought you were going to say, like, because I don't think this was anything close to a DSA moment. If you look at especially the... No, I don't either. Yeah, yeah. If you look at some of these governor candidates especially, there's they. So I think the average Congress person, the average like elite at the top of the party or whatever.

And the Democratic side didn't really learn anything from 16, 24. But people did. And that became clear to me last night. Some of these governors, it's Governor of Texas, Governor of Ohio. There's like 0% woke. They don't want to talk about cultural war stuff. It's like, no, no, just shut up. I'm not here to talk about that. What I'm here to talk about is the economic power of regular people versus the elite versus, you know, that's what I'm here to like deal with. It's just working people and listening to them and fulfilling their needs. And that was like... That was what grabbed

by the throat and 16. And then yeah, I mean, in in a in a weird way, if you look at it, the most successful campaigns last night were very much like Trump's campaign with just a much better bedside manner. It's it's just center left, which in a lot of ways Trump is. Yeah. Like, no, incidentally. But yeah, like now, obviously, there's there's some crazies that made it too. But like.

A lot of the statewide stuff was like, you listen to Canada, like, man, I wish I could have this person. But anyway, let me get the rundown. S&P. So first of all, at one point last night, stocks were down like 2%. And then they just came ripping back. But S&P closed up 1.65. Equal weight even better than that. It was up almost 1.9 by the end. Small caps up 1.5. The Q's up a little less than 1%. So max seven up 2.2. So basically ai got hit down like three percent Hyper scalars up. We'll talk about why with that all world x us really nice day Up about two percent. So beat our market. That's because the dollar was down point three six dollars down point three six because oil got smacked Inside of max seven everything was up big except for elana chips Oil closed the day down eight percent almost eight bucks The two big takeaways from the market today were obviously the war is over, and AI is over. We'll get into that big time. Because dollar rates, oil down, you had gold up a little over three, it's silver up five, you had gold miners up nine, platinum, palladium up, even copper pretty flat actually. So maybe still playing the AI trade a little bit. In yields, you had the two year down five, and you had the 10 year down eight.

the 30 year down six, vol down about 11% on the day. It's a very good day to not be long, vol. Yeah, so there you go. It was over and AI's dead. That's, yeah. So as I was looking around filtering all this stuff through, what do you call those? Yeah, no, right. It was going to go off in cancer. But when you're filtering this stuff through, kind of digesting all this stuff, You know, and you and I haven't even talked about this. Do you know what I think might be a big winner from last night? International, especially Chinese tech. It could be, yeah. I think it could be a big winner because A, and I don't think it's going to be a straight line. I don't think it's a simple thing, but I think that the election results last night got us closer to the resumption of dollar down and the devaluation trade.

for a variety of reasons, meaning the one thing that liberals and Trump are going to be able to agree on is spending money. I think that they are going to make it more likely that the war ends sooner. That's certainly what oil markets think. And if you get a pullback in energy prices, like we've said from the beginning of this tumult, or not tumult, but the this sideways grind that the market's been on for quite a while, that if you're playing a breakout, I still don't think the names you want to own are in the U.S. and I'll still stick to that. I look at, again, getting back to the Delta evaluations, which is insane. And I kind of think the biggest trade, everybody's looking at U.S. markets, I think the best, I think it's highly possible.

The best trades in the best places to be after last night's is back on the international side of things. I think that's yeah, that that's one of those things I have conviction and they never never changed for me and obviously hasn't done well because of the war And still hasn't I mean you the cues were up less than 1% You know, you got Italy up 4% or Ireland up 4% South Africa up 4% Turkey up 4 and a half UAE up 5 Well, I know for Hong Kong up four. Well, think about the certainty. You know, yeah, I mean, I mean, even the tariff side of it, right? Like that's gotten hamstrung. They're going to tie him up. And I think a lot of these things that had made those markets sell off, I think that they've been greatly reduced. And I'm not making a political statement, right? Like I'm not saying that's a good or bad thing. I'm just merely talking about the impact it has on.

on asset prices. And I think the other thing too is, here's the other reason why I like Chinese tech here, or I may, it's still early. But what the market is telling, now I'm not, I don't have a high level of confidence in this at all because I think in my opinion, I think the market's being laughably naive. I do not think the vast majority of politicians, even the ones who are paying mouse service to it, are going to be anywhere close to the resistance against the proliferation of data centers like so many people think. And the reason I don't is because they're going to take the money. So hold on. I think I agreed with this a couple of months ago. But if money could do it, I mean, think about last night, the president offered everybody a 5,000 check if they won, and they didn't even come close to winning. Elon spent half a billion dollars on politicians. They all got smoked.

It's not just money. If you look at Texas, think about this, Governor Abbott, who was about to be a four-term governor in Texas, he had actually pulled back on data center stuff pretty hard because he saw where this was going. It is a bipartisan issue. In some of these states, including battleground states, you had no choice but to do it. The point I'm making is if you don't follow through, you will get smoked. I think you have to do stuff. I and if Bezos comes in and throws a bag of money at you, you're going to get smoked harder. If you do it, if you take it, that's my view. They're going to get this. Politicians got a politician, buddy. They're always going to bend the need of money and power. Unless the people are against it enough. OK, but you're making my point for me. OK, all of this to me, if they do really pull back.

and restrict data centers and restrict this whole move and it cuts into capex. China's a winner. China's going to fill that void. No, and that's where I'm sitting there saying, now look, I will stand here 90 days, 180 days from now, and without reservation admit that I'm wrong, if I'm wrong. I'm looking at this and going, for all these reasons, I'm going, I think the biggest winner coming out of this is Chinese Tech. if these people follow through. But that requires, yeah, the follow through. But I think we are going to get it right now. The way I phrased it to you guys in Texas today was that I'm not saying, you know, I think this stuff has teeth because these governors are not kidding. They got elected on a mandate to do this stuff. They really ran on it. So when I was in Georgia and Florida, I mean, there were political ads that were literally just about data centers. They were like, look at this guy. He likes data centers. And like those people got destroyed.

What is the public? This is such a strange fascination. And it's, you know, it's not new. People get hung up on weird stuff. I'm, look, I do not like the idea of these massive data centers going into these places, you know, like I understand the pushback, the NIMBY, all the, all the degrees. I think we all understand all the pushback in state centers. I do think it's gotten to a pretty crazy level though, like how data centers are now the boogeyman. So if you think about it, if you're a working person, you're barely making it to me, and your government is trying to throw a bunch of tax breaks, Jeff Bezos to come build a big data center. And the whole purpose of this data center is probably at least partially to take your job away in 10 years. And it's going

to make your electric bill go up, and it might mess with water and you're a farmer nearby. It's not insane. I do think... No, it's not insane.

They use the less water than golf courses. Like the stuff gets taken far out of context. But yeah, it's not insane, but it is extraordinarily sophomore and short-sighted. Meaning, whether you like it or not, you're in a race and you don't get a choice of whether you want to compete in that race. And I hate admitting that. I hate admitting that. I don't want to give passes to the Sam Altman's of the world. And I'm not. I think the debate around this is ridiculous. Yes, you have to compete. Yes, you have to go. The only thing you cannot afford to do is not participate in the AI race. But that's not going to happen. And if you slow down, it doesn't mean that you are seeding anything. Especially since it looks like China just distills our stuff anyway.

Now, if they were the leading edge and you feel like they need to catch up, that would be different. Chase, no, I don't disagree with anything that you said on balance on the face of it. But at the same time, one of the things that is the reason that we win these races is because we let people run. Like meaning it's kind of what makes America America. And do we need to have regulations in place? Yes. Do we need to regulate it in a smart manner so regulations do not equal the codifying of the top companies in a permanent, you know, hierarchy where, you know, they're, you know, regular. That's been our business model for 30 years, but yeah. Oh, yeah. Oh, I know. I know. And that's one of the biggest reasons why we're here. It's one of the reasons that every election, you're swinging back and forth this way, right? But Yeah, I I just you cannot stand in the way of technological advancement like this and it's scary. I think so. I think you can because because it's scary like like You think about you think about drug development. We don't just let people do whatever they want with drug development You think about nuclear weapons. You can't do that as a private company But with this which could just hold on hold on just as big of consequences as a nuclear weapon or unfettered drug cells like This is that big a deal and we're just like, I don't do what you want, man. Okay, but put it back in the context of stock prices. If the price action is correct today, what the market is telling you is we're going to greatly crack down and slow the expanse of AI. Okay, A, I don't believe that's going to happen, not in a meaningful way. I think it

already is. How? Texas has already put a lot in place under Abbott and then he got rottled.

by the Democrat who promised stronger resistance to data centers. It's going to slow down. They'll go somewhere else. Hold on. Hold on. Texas is 27 percent of the pipeline right now. If they go somewhere else, that makes my point. It slows down big time. Like I'm not saying it ends. I'm not saying we're done doing a higher. We're up the last. No, but I'm saying it's going to slow down. Yeah. But there were no data centers being built 24 months ago in Texas. That's not true. It's it's okay. What what what 30 months ago? Whatever. I mean if you go if you go if you go current future Texas is the biggest data center state by like a factor of two Yes, but I mean this these aren't nuclear reactors. They haven't been working on this stuff for 15 years It's not like you can't pivot really quick when you're prepared to throw 300 billion dollars Like that's stopping anybody right now. What is it? That's the point though. Yeah, that's that and that's why I don't think chasing hyperscalers because this is going to get them back to free cash flow because they have to store capex. It makes sense. It just makes their capex more expensive because they have to pick up sticks and move somewhere else. Yeah. And what have these people said? They're going to get their data centers. Maybe not here domestically.

But maybe they'll start parking them in Uruguay. Maybe they'll start parking them in Venezuela with some deal they're going to come in. Who knows? But I'm just saying- The problem is they're unpopular everywhere they go. Yeah. Yeah. But when you're backing them with that much money, you're going to find takers. Yeah. And they were, they're going to build these things. It's just going to take longer than it is. Yeah, well- But it's probably the best thing that could ever happen to it because they were going to build them too, too many and too fast. This could be the best thing ever for them. And I think that's what the market is saying. It's like, Thank goodness these idiots have to slow down before they build 100,000 extra miles of track than they need like the 1880s or whatever, you know, like I I don't Yeah, I think you're giving the market a little bit too much credit. I think a lot is punishing these guys for a long time for overspending So now it thinks it gets a chance for them to underspend I mean, I don't under when you're talking about the level of capex these guys are spending with no

visibility to profit with no visible Line to profitability anywhere in sight. I think it's really hard to make the argument. They're getting punished I mean look oracles in like a 50 drawdown googles. Well, yeah, but percent drawdown like they're getting okay. Okay. Okay. You named two Metas hanging in there pretty well. It got rocked around a little bit Microsoft's hanging in there pretty damn well, but because they're going capex light. They're still positive free cash flow Well, so their outperformance is directly tied to them spending less. You know, yeah, but no barely But yeah, my whole point on this is that I didn't think the market was punishing them. I thought the market was being pretty judicious about it, meaning the idea that you're going to get multiple expansion on your stock while you're spending multiples of your annual revenue. But they're not getting multiple expansion, though. Well, no. But what I'm saying is people treat the absence of multiple expansion as if these things are getting punished.

I just don't see it that way. Most of them are in a drawdown. I do think they're getting punished. While S&P earnings are growing 30%, and these things are in drawdowns, to me, it's a punch. Well, I mean, OK, we can't keep flipping back and forth between a philosophical look at them and a financial look at them. The fact that these things are trading where they are and that most of them have flipped cash flow negative? they shouldn't be trading at their highs. I mean, they've gone cash for some of the greatest, some of the greatest cash thousands in history. Oh, well, yeah, but they wouldn't see, you wouldn't be seeing the cloud revenue and the compute revenue going through the roof either. So, I mean, I think they're offsetting. I will say this, I think it's opening up a really impressive opportunity in chips.

I just don't, I do not think, look, if this cycle gets slowed down a little bit, and that seems to be the narrative that people are talking about. You needed a lot more than a little bit of a slowdown to materially impact a lot of these chip makers. We were talking about backlogs, shortages, Apple's justifying 100 price hike on their phones because of the acceleration. So if you just slow that move down a little bit, Even if you slow it down 15-20%, you're not going to collapse those margins. The chip makers couldn't keep up with demand anyway, right? So you might get the market more in balance, but I don't see anything here on the chip side. If all of the research that we have

done and all of the people talking about the shortage and nobody can get these things, I don't think all of a sudden this is going to flip them into surplus.

You know what I mean? Like, I don't think they're going to all of a sudden be like, dude, we got to figure out where we're going to send these H H 1000s. Nobody wants them now. Right. I think there's still plenty of takers. So again, I think you got to watch those margins and you got to watch pricing action like a hawk. I think I agree. But I think they were growing so fast that there's that that growth slowing down. The market's going to punish it. But but I think I I agree with you more medium term. Like, yeah, if you slow down, you just you just make the runway longer. You make the profitability window longer and you make the catastrophic. Oh my god. We built too much like gap Smaller so like to me is this is great for It's great for the industry. I mean I'd be great for the stock prices in the next six months or a year or whatever I think it's great for the industry because the big risk the industry was going from man Look at this we're growing 200% so like oh wow no one wants our chips anymore because they all got enough That was the big risk and this this brings that down But it also brings the growth rate down, and the market's going to look at the growth rate and go, no, I only like chips and they're growing 100%, you know, not 70, like get out of here. I do think that's possible. They'll say, yeah, 70% growth rate. Those are Pikers numbers, right? I mean, we see it with stocks all the time. Like sometimes the stock price is only because growth. You don't get to stop growing 100%. Yeah, yeah, regardless. Yeah, it's like the only thing the market actually only thing it seems to even care about or acknowledge.

A hundred times sales have grown a hundred percent. I don't even want you if you're growing at 80. Yeah. You know, the other one, and this is completely anecdotal, but the other thing that's got me fired up about international stocks is nobody else's. I mean, you saw pop today, right? But everybody's sitting there going, oh, what does this mean for hyperscalers? What does it mean? Exactly. Nobody's exactly. And I'm sitting there going, US stocks weren't in a drawdown. International's been getting lit, right? Getting pounded. I'm sitting there adding up all these things and I'm adding up all the criteria from last night, dollar down, energy prices falling, less risk of proliferation of the mess going on in the Middle East, all the stuff

we've talked about. And I'm going, this feels like that moment in Wayne's World where you grab the hockey net and run back out in the middle of the street and yell game on. So this is a perfect place to pivot to the oil stuff because we'd also disagree there. And that does make me, what kind of disagree I should say?

That makes me nervous about just all in on on metals all in on on you know ex US because In some ways, I think you're right like the odds of the war Ending or ending sooner like in some ways had to have gone up like this was so in your face catastrophic You would think It would it would move people to be like let's let's stop doing that like that really hurt however I think there are a lot of nuances here. One, no one's going to do anything about it in at least the next two months because this Congress won't even be seated. There's a kind of a game theory, strategic political perspective here that I can't get out of my head. And that is, if you're the Democratic Party, I would say the number one reason you just had this great night was the war. Why in the world would you want to give the president an off ramp to stop making the biggest mistake he's ever made?

Because you can say give us the White House in two years from now, you can say give us the White House because we brought an end to this horrible war. But that also gives Trump the ability to be like, we were going to win until the Democrats killed the war. He's got no more coattails. The best way for Democrats to dominate 28 is this war to last until 28. That's my point. He's not a lame duck. He's a duck with an arrow through his neck. He's a dead duck. The biggest question politically is how much they're gonna run from it. Did you read that tweet from Vance? That tweet from Vance was jaw-dropping to me. I don't think I have ever heard a statement where a vice president made something that pivoted harder away from the president that he served in that one. So he said the president himself said yes because he ran war, but I would do it again. I mean, it's not like the Trump's running from that. Yeah, but that's the Roy Cohn playbook.

Trump is there is Trump could blow up Trump Tower and still try to sell you on how he intended to do it and that it wasn't a mistake Never made a mistake. He's never gonna acknowledge it. So His his coalition is over it is dead. Everybody's running from it. He is now a toxic political brand. It's

over it's Yeah, and if people don't anyone that doesn't get off the ship has no prayer in two years, so And the thing his superpower there is no ship The thing that gave him his most power was I I will primary you because he had a good record there So he killed people's careers now that's backfired because you ran off the Tom Tillis's of the world and they got replaced by Democrats So like or or or you killed John Cornyn's career. Hmm. I think exactly Those two were just on those two were on Trump straight up. Yeah, like yep And in South Carolina when you throw in Lindsey Graham's sister God bless her who, you know, I'm not saying anything about him being she was a bad candidate. Like that wasn't that was crazy. Like you deserve to lose those seats.

Look, and to be fair to her, she's not a career politician. I'm sure you and I probably see pretty eye to eye on that, but you put somebody up on a debate stage that can't answer the basic question she was asked. What an insult to the constituency. And it's not like your, it's not like it's a house seat and she represents 9,000 people or something like Senate. You don't get to, you don't get to be like, I don't know anything about foreign policy. I'm not into that. But, but I did stay at a holiday in Express last night. She had the ultimate answer. Right. Like it literally was the political answer. I stayed in holiday and express last night. She's like, well, I don't have experience with that, but I did have family in the military. You're just like, yeah, well, we, who didn't, lady? We all have relatives in the military. Like, you're, may I remind you, you're running for Senate. Yeah. Well, and, and, and it's just the political arrogance of Trump. Like, that's like, you don't get to the last, no, the last interview that I was just on, we The last interview I was just taking part in, we were talking about this exact same thing. And we were talking about Trump, the interview that he did and the rationale that he put forward regarding why he didn't back Cornyn and why he back Paxton. And basically he just said Paxton was loyal and Cornyn wasn't.

And I just sat there and I went, that is why you, that's why you just got killed in the elections. Inflation, interest rates, AI spending, midterm results, you name it, you can't control any of it. But there is one thing that you can control, and that is how your retirement portfolio is positioned for 2027. Join Bulwark Capital, Zach Abraham, for his free Taking Control live webinar, November 19th at 3.30pm Pacific Time. At our webinar, we'll

review the forces that shaped this year's markets. and what we're watching as investors head into next year. Bullwork is focused on risk management, always looking for opportunities to lower your risk, lower cost, and give your retirement as much upside as possible. You can't control what happens next.

but you can control how you prepare for it. Join Zach's Taking Control webinar, November 19th, 3.30 p.m. Pacific time. It's live and it's free. Register now at knowyourriskpodcast.com and subscribe to Zach's daily podcast on YouTube and at knowyourriskpodcast.com. That's knowyourriskpodcast.com. The opinions expressed in this program are for general informational purposes only and are not intended to provide specific advice or recommendations for any individual or on any specific security. Any references to performance of securities are thought to be materially accurate and actual performance may differ. There we go. All right. So we are back. Sorry, a little technical difficulties. Where are we at? Do you remember where we were at? Not really. Let's just start starting new. Yeah, the war. Well, the other interesting thing about the war, I had this written in my notes here too.

The outcome of the war, I agree with you, it's not a certain, the Democrats are not nowhere near, they're nowhere near the anti-war party that they were when you and I were kids either. So that is one thing that you've, I just think though, that the anti-Trump sentiment is so virulent, that this is his war, they know it wasn't popular. It's just hard for me to look at the events of last night and think that this does not hasten a conclusion in the Middle East I think it should but but internally for them to be like wow This this was bad for us. Let's get out of here flipside though is like I don't expect the Democrats to do that much because to me like they're drowning and and helping is like In the war up from like starving the money to the Pentagon or whatever would a make a bunch of enemies in the Pentagon Probably they don't want to do and be it's like it's like a life preserver to this administration to get them out of this war. But another aspect of this is that if we're going to get out, what does that look like? Because if it's a negotiation, at this point, Iran's laughing. They're dunking on its left and right on social media and everything. And hey, they just got a massive

political victory here, obviously. Their negotiating stance probably just got tougher, right? They know they got.

us cornered at this point politically and financially like you name it. It's like, I don't think they're going to be like, all right, let's give you guys a good deal now. Like they're just going to be like literally everything we want. No, no, no is answer, but sign it or taking it. Oh, I agree. And they also know that pretty much every single threat now Trump makes about ratcheting things up or deploying a nuclear bomb. Those options just got taken off the table for him. I do think we could have us still have a pretty significant ramp up in the next month or two. Like I don't see like no one's gonna stop that in my opinion. I don't think and we just sent an elant aircraft over there. We only have two of those and we just sent one to the Middle East. Like there are still signs that like things are about to happen. That's why I don't personally don't understand why oil would be down this much just because the Democrats won the midterms.

Okay. So you just kind of summed up my whole take. I think the market moves make sense. I think the amplitude of the market moves don't. Yeah. I agree with that. If the oil is down 2% and it's like, hey, the odds changed a little bit here. I'd be like, that's fair. Yeah. Dow up one and a half S&P up one little weaker dollar. I get that. The amplitude, a lot of the moves. For instance, I'm not trying to, I'm not just for anybody. I'm not going to go on a tie right here. Apple's market cap was up 300 billion dollars today. Yeah, that's stupid. Right. That's my whole point. The amplitude of these moves has, to me, has no basis. I think the direction of them makes some sense. Now, the other thing is, like we talked about, we're coming in with... Because they played a big role there. You've been in oil. There's a lot more longs than there were two months ago. Five months ago. Well, yeah. And when you roll any type of event into a negative gamma environment, it's going to exacerbate it, right?

A lot of firms said de-gross coming into this, so they got to buy back in. I think a lot of that happened, so the one pause I would give a lot of investors is, hey, like we've said all along, let the market suss this out because it may not think the same thing or anywhere nearly as much as it thinks that thing, three days from now as opposed to what it does today. I agree with you. I

think that the move in oil is overcooked too. It's funny. You said 2%. I was thinking to myself, look at two, two to 3% sell off an oil. I can get that oil drop at almost eight, 10% like that. Whoa, whoa, whoa, whoa, whoa. And to your point, to your point, um, it's hard for me to not look at this and go, look, I'm not saying the, I'm not saying the Iran conflict is going to end next week, but whatever you thought Iran's going to get.

I think you have to assume they're going to get more now. And the reason I say that is because, look, Trump can still do some things over the next two months. And we've talked about this, but this hamstrings him in a lot of ways based on what he can do there and what they're going to look. Anyway, I'm with you. I think the market is saying, oh, this thing's over. I don't think that they can. I don't think it's one of those situations. But I think it, I think if you're looking at it just from the set, just from, like if you're looking at this whole scenario in the Middle East and you're worried about the proliferation and, you know, Tucker Carlson's going off the rails talking about how Trump wants to nuke, you know, Iran, if that, if those kind of things were a big concern for you, I think that all of all those things got extraordinarily less likely now.

I never thought. Yeah. Now he might get 25th amendment for that. Yeah. Yeah. Well, and I look, I'm probably not the best guy to speak to this because I was the one that was sure we weren't going to go into Iran in the first place. But I, you know, I do think this takes takes a lot of the worst case scenarios as far as us amping things up off the table. So I think, I think the odds of doing something short term though just went up. And the reason I'll say that is if you think back to last week, I was saying, man, you know, like, They're trying to job on it down and it's not working. Like the playbook has been job on oil down 15 20% bomb because then you then you buy yourself the time for the bombing to bring oil back up 20% They couldn't get it done. So I was like, man, can they bomb with oil at the highs? Well now all of a sudden it was 15% off the highs. It opens up the window to be like, all right, let's go for it. Okay, here's something else too. And we've talked about this in the past And you've talked about it actually a lot talking about how, you know the Trump appointees and the people he puts around him are all sick of fans and yes men and all that kind of stuff. It appears to me from the outside that Trump, now, I think it's fair to make the

arguments of his own construction, but Trump has, he is being a president in an echo chamber, right? And Trump loves being popular.

I think there was a significant part of him that right up until the election started rolling in last night, he believed Trump, Trump was going to carry the day. They told him I'm on the ballot. Yep. He knows he got his ass handed to him. He also knows he can say whatever he wants. He also knows that stopping Iran from nuking LA in London was not at all why he went in there. And it's pretty clear from the voting that everyone like no one bought that at all. Yeah, right. So I think Trump is much less likely to let Trump is not ideological. He's not. Yeah, totally. And I don't think I think I think the public face that he was putting on this war was all about the selection and his unwillingness to take an L and him thinking that he could out trump the negative impact of the war.

Now that he got his ass handed to him in a war that I don't think he wants to be in in the first place. I just he obviously hated it for six months. Yeah. Yeah. And I just think that now you've taken away. There is no W possible, though. And even he knows that. But there wasn't before this either. There he didn't know that. He didn't know that. I'm open to that. Yeah. He's unwilling. I know. But it was obvious in February and look at. Yeah. Everybody that supported him didn't think it was obvious in February. Do you know how many debates I got on this on other podcasts that I'm on regularly? Not a single one of them agreed with our take on this thing from the beginning. I know. But it was at least obvious three months ago when, you know, it was obvious when you gave up on the MOU. It was obvious two months ago, three months ago, when you still had time to like, maybe at least save a couple seats, you know? But dude, we're talking about Trump. Like Trump...

Trump has belief in Trump. That's your point. No one was going to tell him that because he didn't have those kind of people around him. And he has belief in himself like children have belief in Santa Claus. He thinks he can pull a rabbit out of the hat at any time. He thinks that the only time he takes an L is when he acknowledges he takes an L. And then even when he takes an L, he tries to spend it like a dummy. Right? Like it's just who he is. And so I'm looking at this now and going, there is no win possible left in the war

for him. He's going to lose interest to move on. I thought that's six months ago. So so maybe I'm just I'm I know, but the color by my thought that he would take his toys and go home six months ago. Well, no, but the problem and the reason I didn't think that was going to happen six months ago was because that would require him to take an L. It came really close with the MOU, though. If they didn't start shooting at stuff, he was he was co-signing on the L. I mean, he went to. Oh, yeah. No, he was trying to get out. I he went to Versailles of all places to sign the agreement with the Iranians. I mean, Yeah. Now we're all, we're all reading tea leaves from the outside looking at, I think that was a classic Trump moment where he sees everything as a negotiation. They said yes to the MOU. He thought that that would be a starting point and that he'd be able to ferret a couple of those things out. Then they said no, then details of the MOU got released. He started taking, he hated that he took for sure. And he went right back to a fighting posture, right? Like just It's not like he gets to get out of this without now. Maybe you're right. Maybe he gets to get out of this a little bit. Oh, he can blame it on the he can blame it on the Democrats now But that's why I don't think they'll play ball and I think they'll make him eat it because well, I know but blame it on the Democrat like this like part of it is like I and look I don't think Trump has dementia or anything like that I don't but it's on some ways though for sure like he's different Well, I think like cognitively all messed up, but I'm saying like He was five years ago, but who is in that age like it's not Yeah, I mean his administration is night and day different from the first one shockingly so And the decisions they come to and the postures they take you were just like I said, man I this will just go down as the greatest political cell phone in history to me where You just party wants to be in the room because you're sitting there going I I would have been dying to hear the lies. They were telling themselves five months ago When this right, that's why you don't round yourself a bunch of loyalists that did your boots Well, you and I were sitting back and going talk about a slow-motion train wreck. I mean you could see it when this thing got started You're sitting there going we got some of the most contentious midterms coming up in seven eight months You're gonna violate one of the biggest reasons people voted for you Which is gonna dis make you unable to carry through with your other campaign promise about bring big and remember and just from the From the beginning there was another one right after he got elected was like, yeah, we're taking down inflation I was like

that is the dumbest political statement ever And the reason why economically speaking inflation's a grease fire, man It always is regardless of who's in charge It's hard to put out and just when you think you've got to put out it pops up again And I remember saying on another interview I was like look I think that's a really bad political move to come out and say that you're gonna best inflation You may have very little control over that. And judging by the fiscal restraint you have shown, I doubt you are going to be able to tackle inflation. I mean, anyway, I just hit every turn. And you said something that I pushed back on because there was, and I think that you were more right about this, that there was There was an aspect of the first Trump administration where I think that he made some mistakes about people that were on his cabinet and people that were on his team that were deep staters. If you go, you're a deep state guy. Look, if you don't understand the existence of a deep state, call it something else. It's not a political term. Call it the administrative state or whatever you want to call it. But there is absolutely an entrenched interest that has a big hand on the scales of what we do as a country.

And those people are unelected. So call it whatever you want, right? But when you looked at, he just pivoted too hard. So it's like, it's like football teams whenever you like, you have a really nice coach and you just feel like you have to pivot to the jerk coach. Like you don't have to, but everyone does. Everyone always goes big style flip. And I think he went from like, I get way too much pushback from inside the Oval Office. So instead of going 50, 50 on pushback people and bootlickers, I'm just going to go full blown. Yeah. And the only people I want you bringing to me are influencers that love me and will swear allegiance to me. That's it. Until, until they say something negative about me and then get rid of them too. Yeah. And I just, he threw Abbot under the bus last night as a rhino and you're like, man, this guy's been like a hardcore Trump guy from the jump. And, and he just, they just went 90 miles an hour into a brick wall and they've been watching that brick wall through the windshield for a year and a half. And they just drove right into it.

It really is remarkable. Okay, so what else do we have? I mean, there's so many different angles to look at this from. So I'll say one thing for me, and I mentioned the tech today. The space I still like most, healthcare, biotech,

pharma, however you look at it, like all that stuff. And one of the big reasons is it ain't caught up in all this. I don't have to game out what it means. That this election like I don't have to do 8d chess in my head on the war or on How much data centers are gonna slow down or like I can just be like That stuff's doing well that stuff has tailwinds that stuff hasn't cared about rates and it normally does There's a lot of innovation there Like I can just be like yeah, I like that Well, there's another angle too. It doesn't care what the dollar does the same way that other stuff does well, no, and it's not and the utilization of AI as it relates to biotech and healthcare, that's gonna, it's biotech and healthcare, man. You know, like that's gonna be, like I wouldn't be surprised if some biotech companies could get away with building a data center. Well, yeah, it's a data center, but we're building it because we're trying to make better medicines. People are like, oh, okay, well, that, you know, that makes sense. Yeah. And there were dozens of referendums at the, county and city level across the country last night. And let me tell you, clean sweep, they hate Janna centers. Like if it was on the ballot, it got smashed like 80% for sure. But what's interesting about that is a lot of those are like apps on size, caps on power, stuff like that. So like, hey, if you want to, if you want to come bring your miniature one in, do your thing, man. You just can't come in here with some behemoth and take all of our water and power.

or whatever the case may be. So like that distributed smaller stuff, which you know me, I think it's the future anyway. It maybe accelerates that, right? So like, I think you're right. Like if you have a, just an on-premises mini data center, maybe it's not, maybe it's the size of like a garage of racks or whatever. Like nobody cares about that. You could do all you want with that. And a lot of people may see like big data center seems really painful. Let's just go on-prem with our own. with their own setup so we could do our own little AI intramodel. And you're right, because the average hospital is already doing that. They don't care. Right. Claw. Yeah, so, yeah, they can make a miniature one. And remember, miniature one can still be pretty dang big, right? I mean, these things are massive. So if I was one of those guys right now, I'd be sitting there going, hey, guys, why don't we do this? Why don't we spin up our own data center? And let's build it with some over capacity.

And we'll rent that compute out and it'll pay for the cost of the data center itself Yeah, you could just have smaller Legos moving forward. Yeah, that's a possibility So I so I agree with you. I look at biotech and healthcare and I just see all systems go and speaking of x us our china healthcare etf was up 6.6 today like that That kind of sits at the crossroads of both and that's just one day i'm not gonna get too carried away but like saying xbi like you look at The space is not like it blew the market out of the water today other than the China one obviously, but like good good little bounce Good little bounce for Ali Bob off that hundred dollar level Very much so a lot of that kind of ex-US stuff had it had a gun software. It was nice today Chase what is on AI? It's gonna hit too hard bucket for me. That's what I'll say Yeah, I agree with you but what but what is the what would the constraints be because I think For instance, if you really do start restricting data center construction here in the United States, I personally don't think that slows down the move. I think they're going to look for other places to put it. What would present them? Mexico would be another place you could put them. We already have done that a decent amount. They're already kind of back in a way, though. The localities are already getting a little angry there and stuff. Now, that will happen to Canada, too. Don't get me wrong. Canada's got a lot of cheap natural gas that They're happy to throw at it, I think. Hey, dude, there's a lot of places in South America where you can park some Walmart-sized data centers, and even if the local people don't like it, you throw some of that big tech money around, they'll tell the local people to go shove it up their pipes, and they'll build a data center anyway. And with the money, these guys are willing to throw around. I don't see domestic restrictions slowing them down at all. And make no mistake, the Broly Garcs will start throwing Bags of money at Democrats now like it's just they're gonna pivot who they got. Oh I've posted a picture of of all of them at the front row At the inauguration and I remade it where they all look like the blue man group There's oh, yeah. Yeah, and I said this is gonna be exhausting because they're gonna do it. They actually What's gotten underrated is they already started some of them started to throw some packed money towards towards the other side stuff They they know what's going on Hey, so is the Israel crowd you know I found out last night that I was not aware of the Adelson was her name share. I can't remember her first name. I can't hear him. I think it is. She was a significant contributor to Talorico's Senate campaign. Oh, wow. I did not know that. Interesting. Well,

I mean, you know, it's not because she's a fan of Talorico. Well, to be fair, the guy he was running against in the state of Texas, like everyone knows the guy's trash. Everyone hated him. Like it was that was just that was malpractice as a who you put up against Talorico.

Oh, I agree. But I know, but I mean, when when Sheldon Adelson, where when Adelson, I mean, they are the public funders ever. So yeah, I mean, when they're giving money to Tallorico for before I almost I almost feel like the Adelson's have turned into like a miniature APAC. You know what I mean? Like it just feels like it just feels like they're trying to throw money and get it to stick to any politician they possibly can. That's kind of the way it works. If we're being honest. Yeah, so some some of these people have actually have a side and they're not playing it. Most of them just, they just need to win. They don't care. Yeah. Yeah. Well, it's like you brought up the tech bros and the tech oligarchs, right? Like just they're going to, they're going to buddy up to whoever's in power. I mean, I saw someone say, someone said, Chometh will have his pronouns in his profile within a day. And he actually responded with his pro. He said in my, my pronouns are I'm short. And he marked the basically the bottom when he said that, but. Yeah. He's, he's got air. There's another big lesson in there.

Anybody that gets long or short because of singularly because of an election, don't listen to them. Every once in a while, there's some clear cut thing that like is obviously going to be even that. I'll take that back because usually the most obvious trades are the dumbest trades you can do. Yeah. When Trump won, you were supposed to go, you know, you're supposed to short all the, all the like. Green energy stuff that's ripped after he won now that he got killed after that everything ripped I remember everybody going short the market because of Trump gets elected the market's gonna plummet and we're looking around going Huh? No, it's gonna rip. He's a businessman. He's gonna let the money flow. He's gonna open the spigots He's gonna do what guys in his position do like a Billionaire like Trump gets elected office and you think that's bearish the stock market like come on Right now at the same time I will say this When Trump got elected in 2016, when futures were limit down overnight, that's when I was convinced he'd won, right? Like I was looking and going, okay, I'm convinced he won. And then I thought, oh, and then it just went ballistic. But I mean, when you

looked at the things that he wanted to do and said he was doing, that's why I was laughing so hard. Yeah, lower corporate taxes for one, like that's... Yeah, all the leftists that believed with like a religious type zeal that Trump was just devastation for the economy. And then it hits and you're like, Why why why did you think like easy money less regulation lower corporate tax rates? Yeah, that's gonna really hurt in hit earnings, right? Like it made no sense and and I was also the one I got I was on a Conservative podcast the other day and they're like, you know, what's if the blue wave happens? How bad could it get and I go? Honestly, I don't think it's gonna get bad at all. Yeah, they were like what now I wouldn't have predicted that But I was like, look, guys, I think that regardless of how this election plays out, I think it will have very little impact on underlying stocks. And I was like, if anything, it's probably going to be positive because markets love gridlock. One thing markets feel really good about, and I guarantee you it was part of the rally today, certainly not all of it. But markets like separated power, they know that It's very unlikely for any crazy, crazy, massively economically upsetting thing to get passed in the next two years. You know what I mean? Now, the interesting thing to me politically here is Trump has already tried to soften his rhetoric a little bit toward Democrats and saying there's things that we have to work on. And they can. I want to be very firm on that. That could be, that's my wildcard. I think he's more than willing to work with them. He is, they can't.

They can't they can't work with safety, but but They may pass some what they perceive to be showbills And they got to be careful. He will sign he will sign some of that stuff like I think there are some big legislation that could get could get through and I wouldn't be surprised if you get some stuff with enough Bipartisan in the middle to where like the people that truly hate them and it's it everything's orange man bad people They don't even have to vote for it, and he could still get through it. Wait, are you suggesting that we're going to get some real legitimate laws with teeth against insider trading for politicians? Oh, god, no. And we're going to get rid of the carried interest loophole. Is that what you're saying? Probably not that one either. But like, let me ask you this question. I'm not mocking you. I'm mocking the political process. Yeah. Yeah. If they pass Medicare for all, do you think he would sign it? Do you think there's a chance he would sign it? There's like the kind of thing I mean.

I think there's absolutely a chance he could sign it because I think, and in all of this is the outside looking in, I think in his own Trumpian way, and it's very different than you and I would look at it. But one thing that this second term has shown me is that he is far more obsessed with legacy. Yeah, that's the kind of stuff like that. Now you're FDR all over again. Yeah. Let's get the chisel out for Mount Rushmore again. And I, I would be surprised if he's not looking at Nate and going, Hey, do you think I can still win a Nobel? You know, last three years. Yeah. I'm going to, I'm going to actually in this war started. I mean, that, that Iran started with their nukes. You know, the other weird, the other weird thing just, and again, it's nothing new. It just, I guess, you know what I think it is, man? I think it is, and you and I have talked about this.

in a lot of different ways, probably not on the podcast, but just personally. I think a lot of it is, as you go through the world and you experience more life and more events and more things, I would like to think that you learn from those things. I certainly have, probably haven't learned all that I should have from those things, but you glean those and you progress and you start seeing things differently. You start realizing that if everything was a one-party problem that all the political problems would get fixed every four years. And people always, whenever I say that, people go, what do you mean? They go, think about it. Every election in your life, it's the most important election of a lifetime. And here are the things they're going to do. A, is it ever the most important election? And B, do even some of those things get fixed. No, right? So what you start realizing is you realize what the real problem is. You educate yourself.

Then you have these moments where you re-engage with the general public and you it's kind of a cognitive dissonance thing or Or the common knowledge game would be a better way to put it Where you assume that everybody's kind of had that same Evolution and same progress and then you re-engage and you go oh no wait a second Right not in a way of you sitting there extolling your own intellectual superiority your own virtue or anything like that speak for yourself But you just sit back and go, wait a second, you still buy into the cult of personality stuff? Like, for instance, I saw some tweets out today, like, now we're going to find out who's truly loyal to Trump. And I'm like, whoa, whoa, whoa. You guys were actually

loyal to the man and not the ideas? Why would you ever be that way? Like, you don't know him.

He doesn't owe you anything. You think if he saw you on the street, he'd stop to say hi? Like what are you loyal to what? You were loyal to him because his ideas aligned with yours and you thought he was effective at executing on those things, right? He pivoted against you. He sold you out. Why are you loyal to somebody that's gotten all loyalty toward you? That won't change. And again, this is another is a political version of me yelling at the clouds. But but you look around and go, how do we have a country so full of people that are this intellectually underdeveloped that don't understand that the people like that buy into the cult of personality that buy into the idea, we just got to I mean, how many times you're we just need to find somebody that really cares, you know, that really And I'm like, we found that person in every presidential election in my lifetime, and they turned out not to be that person. Wake up, right? And that cult of personality, man, like watching the MAGA folks go down with the ship on this one, where you're like, hey, I don't understand why it's so hard not to sit there and go, look, I voted like I've said a million times. Yeah, I voted for the guy three times.

in his second term, he broke every reason that I voted for him, not every reason. I'm still a fan of what he did on the border and closing that out. There's been some good stuff, yeah. Yeah, yeah, yeah. But yeah, the main, I mean, I don't think the Republican brand was something that needed to be really protected and was something of great value anyway, but whatever was left of it, he nuked. I mean, now I don't think the other thing that I think people need to keep, and we mentioned this earlier, but the other thing I think people need to keep in mind is there's always way too much annualizing and way too much extrapolation of every election, right? And every time there's a big move like this, it's like, this party's dead for the next 50 years. College people will never vote for so party again, right? Right. And I will say like, the parties are really slow to learn lessons. I think the Democrats have just now half learned the lessons of 10 years ago. My expectation is this going to work similarly for the GOP. It's going to take them a long time to actually square up with what just happened, what the real lessons were. And to be clear, the real takeaway is you got to mute out

the noise and focus on making life better for working people. That is the secret to political success and everyone can not, everyone can not help themselves, but to just go flying off in other directions and forget that that was like, that's how you went. Now, locally speaking, they will, they will throw you off a cliff if you don't deliver. They made that obvious. Like it doesn't matter where you are. More so now, more so now than ever. And, and it's setting up a really dangerous, and we've always been like this.

But it's getting so dark. I mean, look at the political shifts that happen in the electorate on a two-year basis now. Yeah, like this political volatility is not good for this country. Now, you have to have some, right? Because that's you don't want one party rule. We suffer under one party rule in the state. And we can talk about that here. We're going to get that good and hard. Like it just is what it is. And then and then you get all the change you need. You know, now some of it's going to be bad. But like that's how it's going to work. Eventually, one party is going to dominate. They're going to change everything and that will actually change your structural problems. But you get all the change you think you need. Yeah. But obviously by playing ping pong back and forth with and where you can't actually do anything. No, no. And that that to me is. Yeah. If you want to lose election start a war, that's pretty clear at this point. I mean, I him getting elected in 2016 should have been.

all the notice you needed for that. His non-interventionism was a massive unseen force multiplier politically. I don't think people realize how much that means to the average person. No, no. And that's why I just will never understand the move. I'll just never get it. Had I been in the room, I'd have been like, hold on. You guys want to do what? Yeah, whoa. No, no, it's you guys. Are you guys joking? It's not even April 1st right now or what do we talk? Whoa. You come on. You got to be kidding me. I'm still I'm still basking in the glow of no more foreign wars, which was a pinnacle of your your deal. I think Maduro changed the world forever. It just did it get it through American politics office access. I agree. And I think and regardless of what anybody says, and I have spoken to some really hardcore Trump fans.

uh that have come around on this where I sat there and I went look man in my opinion if you sit back and look at the sequence of events of leading into the Iran war where we're at now it looks very clear to me which is if you really think this was about keeping nukes out of Iran you believe that on faith because Trump's saying that everything points to I think he saw him I think he saw an opportunity for a domino effect as it relates to every geopolitical misstep the united states have made over the last eight years and that this was going to put his face on mount rushmore and that he was going to clean up every mess that nobody except trump was able to do in the previous years and what a durable toxicating storyline it is i mean it is and when the maduro thing went off that way without a hitch he he was in baby he was in and yeah he just rolled seven three times in a row you're not you're not getting off the dice No, no. And he pressed his bet one too many times. And that's how we got here. You got anything else, man? No, we went very, very long with our two, two merged pieces here. So. Yeah. Well, I mean, there are a lot to discuss. Yeah, it was a big day. If it was a good day to go along. Yeah. Anyway, all right, man. Well, that does it for us. As always, you guys can follow us on social media. I'm at KYR Radio Chase's at Pinecone Mac, bro.

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